SANTHOSH KAPALAVAI

GRC · Cybersecurity · Privacy
Advisory | vCISO

11+
YEARS GLOBAL EXPERIENCE

CONTACT
Chennai, India
+91-8125414012
santhoshkapalavai@gmail.com

MARKETS SERVED
India · USA
Middle East
Southeast Asia
APAC · EMEA

INDUSTRIES
SaaS · BFSI · Healthcare
Technology · Aviation
Fintech · Cloud

TOOLS
Drata · Sprinto · Thoropass
Archer GRC · Hyperproof · Zoho

EDUCATION
PGDM – Supply Chain
Welingkar Institute, 2020
B.Tech – Aircraft Engineering
KHAI, Ukraine

ABOUT

A globally respected **GRC, Cybersecurity & Privacy strategist** trusted by CISOs, CIOs and boards across four continents. Known for turning regulatory complexity into strategic business advantage — building audit-ready organisations, resilient security postures, and lasting client trust across SaaS, BFSI, Healthcare and Technology.

RECOGNITION & MILESTONES

Ranked India's Top 10 Tech Leader — 2025
Handpicked by TradeFlock from across India's entire tech ecosystem — a national peer honour

ISACA-Published Author — Read Worldwide
Whitepaper on India's DPDP Act cited by compliance professionals across 30+ countries

National ISACA Competition Winner
Stood out from India's entire ISACA community for breakthrough privacy compliance innovation

Invited Speaker Across Four Continents
Keynote and panel voice at international GRC, Cybersecurity & Privacy conferences

Aviation Engineer Turned Cyber Leader
Carries mission-critical precision from Indian Air Force aviation into enterprise GRC — a rare professional journey

CORE LEADERSHIP STRENGTHS

Strategic Mindset
Connects GRC programmes directly to board-level business outcomes

Executive Presence
Fluent at C-suite, CISO & board level — risk into business language

CISO-Track Practitioner
End-to-end implementation leader on an active CISO career path

Commercial Instinct
Turns risk challenges into scalable advisory solutions

EXPERTISE

GRC & Risk Management
ISO 27001 · SOX · NIST · CMMI

Cybersecurity Strategy
vCISO · Advisory · Board-Level

Privacy & Data Protection
GDPR · DPDP Act · HIPAA

Audit & Assurance
SOC 2 · HITRUST · ITGC

Vendor & Third-Party Risk
Supply Chain · Multinational

Enterprise Risk Management
Risk Registers · SoA · Controls

Cloud & SaaS Compliance
Drata · Sprinto · Thoropass

Business Growth & Sales
Pre-Sales · Proposals · Revenue

CAREER AT A GLANCE

50+ Enterprises Advised Globally	**15+** Industry Certifications Held
20+ Frameworks Mastered End-to-End	**11+** Years at the Forefront of GRC
4 Continents of Active Delivery	**100+** Professionals Mentored in GRC

ENGAGEMENT MODEL

01 vCISO & Advisory Retainer
Sustained CISO-level governance, risk roadmaps & board-level reporting

02 GRC Programme Implementation
End-to-end framework design, control catalogs, SoA & audit roadmap

03 Compliance Readiness & Certification
Gap assessment to certification for ISO, SOC 2, HITRUST & HIPAA

FRAMEWORKS & STANDARDS

SOC 2 Type II	HITRUST CSF	ISO 27001
ISO 27701	ISO 22301	ISO 20000-1
HIPAA	GDPR	DPDP Act
NIST CSF	SOX & ITGC	CMMI L5

CERTIFICATIONS

CISA	CISM	CCISO
HITRUST CCSFP	GRCP	GRCA
CRCMP	CSOE	PMP
ISO 27001 LA	ITIL V4	Six Sigma GB
GDPR Expert	IBM AI Eng.	IRCA LA

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP TOPICS

- **India DPDP Act —** Implementation strategy & organisational readiness
- **SOC 2 Automation —** Continuous compliance using Drata, Sprinto & Thoropass
- **AI Governance —** ISO 42001 adoption & enterprise AI risk management
- **BFSI Cyber Risk —** AML controls, ITGC & financial services risk frameworks
- **Privacy Engineering —** DPIA, data flow mapping & cross-border transfer governance
- **GRC Maturity —** Scaling organisations from reactive compliance to predictive GRC

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- IRCA Registered Lead Auditor
- CQI Practitioner
- ISACA Member & Published Contributor
- International GRC & Privacy Speaker